subconscious of most Muslim minds in Bangladesh, since for long years before its emergence as a nation, there had been very little connection on a the popular level between East Pakistan and India. As a new nation, Bangladeshis were very conscious of their new identity. At the same time, they were sensitive and apprehensive regarding India which had given its freedom fighters large-scale assistance. There was a natural sense of inferiority which every nation requiring aid resents and which finds expression in different ways. This phenomenon was nothing new. The Americans, for instance, were never as unpopular in Western Europe as they were during the Second World War when they sent their men to battle and, a few years later, when they poured billions of dollars into war-devastated Europe.

It was suggested to the Indira Gandhi government that India must adopt a mature approach which needed to be manifested in the behaviour of Indian personnel in Bangladesh. The general attitude of the Indian officials after Mujib had been killed was that they had been betrayed and this naturally evoked a feeling of resentment and created obstacles in formulating a well-balanced policy for the post-Mujib era in Bangladesh. A government note said:

The attitude should be that what we did in Bangladesh was in our interest and that happened to coincide with the interests of the Bangladesh people as well. The attitude of mutuality and equality is absolutely essential for the success of Indian diplomacy in Bangladesh. That is why the selection of personnel who would be implementing the policies both at the official and non-official level is so very important.